

3.2 The iMac

“The iMac is next year’s computer for \$1,299, not last year’s computer for \$999.”

- Steve Jobs, CEO, Apple

“The best consumer desktop computer on the market.”

- Walter Mossberg; Columnist, Wall Street Journal

The cornerstone of Apple’s desktop computers, the iMac needs no introduction. You would have seen it in movies, in advertisements, on the Internet. The iMac was first introduced in 1998, it has changed form factors as many as three times, but still remains the most popular Mac. Ever.

The launch of the iMac and the return of Steve Jobs were two events that revived Apple from the lows it sunk to in the late 1990s. Almost immediately after returning to Apple, Steve Jobs made sweeping changes to the computer line up at Apple. He replaced confusing model num-



bers and names with simple, iconic brand names. This has been Apple’s tradition since then: simple, easy to recognise products.

Having discontinued the Performa series of computers, Apple needed a computer in a similar price range, a computer that could be targeted at consumers. The iMac was truly a revolutionary product when it was launched. It combined the CPU and monitor in one enclosure, a designing marvel at that time.

The first iMacs were called “Bondi Blue” iMacs, as their body was made of translucent blue plastic. It was also the first computer to not have a floppy drive. Yes, Apple discarded the floppy drive on this computer as early as 1998!